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Test Cases Handoff Guide

Use this guide when you need to describe **scenarios that prove expected behavior, edge behavior, error behavior, or architectural fitness constraints**.

This guide is about evidence that the model or system behaves as intended.

KNOWLEDGE AREA

This guide helps with **proof that behavior works as expected**.

Guide family map

Where this guide sits in the full Blueprint Handoff Atlas family.

ROOT & CROSS-CUTTING

Handoff Atlas

Blueprint Bundle

Metamodel Vocabulary

Migrations

DESIGN

Architecture

Concepts

Domain

Dynamics

Infrastructure

Interactions

Models

Quality

Rules

Story

GOVERNANCE

Capability

Decisions

Motivation

Organization

Roadmap

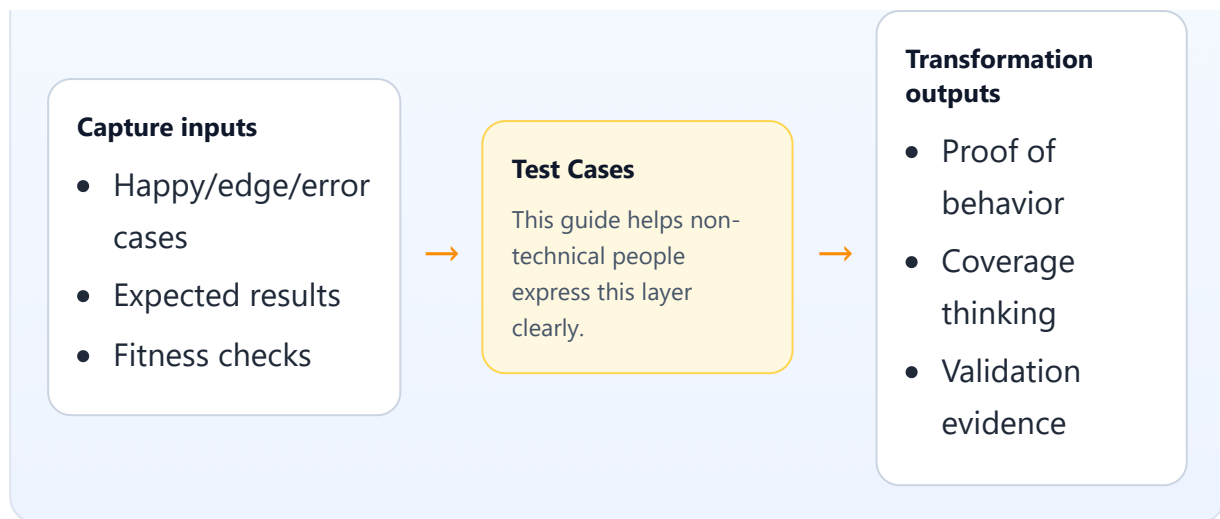
Leverage

Test Cases

Value Stream

Capture → focus → transformation

What to gather first, what this layer focuses on, and what a modeler or AI agent can produce from it.



Main entities in this guide

- **Test Case** — one proof scenario with setup, action, and expected result.
- **Happy Path**, **Edge Cases**, and **Error Cases** — the three main suites used to group **Test Case** entries.
- **Fitness Function** — an automated constraint that checks the architecture or model itself.
- **Validates** — the typed links that say exactly which rules, operations, concepts, stories, or UI elements the test proves.
 - Often confused with: a **Finding** in Quality. A test case proves expected behavior; a finding records a weakness already discovered.

What belongs here

- happy-path scenarios
- edge-case scenarios
- error-case scenarios
- architectural fitness checks

What does not belong here

- a full business story without expected results
- vague quality wishes with no scenario or assertion
- implementation test code

Core things to capture

- the scenario name
- what is being tested

- setup/preconditions
- expected behavior or result
- what Blueprint element it validates

Core relationships to capture

- test case -> operation/rule/concept/story validated
- fitness function -> structural constraint checked
- scenario -> expected outcome or failure mode

Modus operandi

Capture evidence in scenario form:

1. describe the setup
2. describe the triggering action
3. describe the expected result
4. identify what Blueprint element is being validated
5. separate happy, edge, and error cases

Prompt set

- what scenario are we proving?
- what is the setup?
- what action occurs?
- what should happen?
- what rule, concept, or operation does this validate?

Free-text intake template

- **Test name:**
- **Category (happy/edge/error/fitness):**
- **Setup/preconditions:**
- **Trigger/action:**
- **Expected result:**
- **Validates:**

Worked example

- Happy path: customer submits a valid return request and receives confirmation
- Edge case: customer submits a request on the last allowed return day

- Error case: customer selects a non-returnable item and receives validation failure

Layer-specific handoff guidance

For test cases, the handoff should preserve **proof intent**.

The receiver should know:

- what scenario is being tested
- what the expected result is
- what blueprint element or rule it validates
- whether it is happy-path, edge, error, or fitness-focused

If a test note has no expected result, it is not a useful handoff yet.

How this becomes YAML

A technical modeler or AI agent can transform this into categorized test cases and fitness functions linked to the relevant Blueprint entities.

Common mistakes

- naming the test but not the expected result
- forgetting what is being validated
- mixing many scenarios into one case
- omitting edge and error behavior